(P) **7** The graph of $y = pq^x$ passes through the points $(-3, 150)$ and $(2, 0.048)$.

a By drawing a sketch or otherwise, explain why $0 < q < 1$.

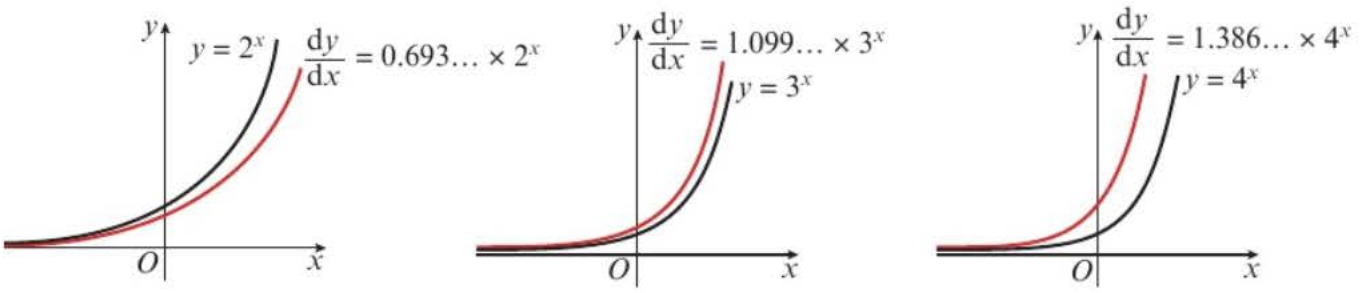
b Find the values of the constants p and q.

Challenge

Sketch the graph of $y = 2^{x-2} + 5$. Give the coordinates of the point where the graph crosses the y-axis.

14.2 $y = e^x$

Exponential functions of the form $f(x) = a^x$ have a special mathematical property. The graphs of their gradient functions are a similar shape to the graphs of the functions themselves.



In each case $f'(x) = kf(x)$, where k is a constant. As the value of a increases, so does the value of k.

Something unique happens between $a = 2$ and $a = 3$. There is going to be a value of a where the gradient function is exactly the same as the original function. This occurs when a is approximately equal to 2.71828. The exact value is represented by the letter e. Like π, e is both an important mathematical constant and an irrational number.

Function	Gradient function
$f(x) = 1^x$	$f'(x) = 0 \times 1^x$
$f(x) = 2^x$	$f'(x) = 0.693... \times 2^x$
$f(x) = 3^x$	$f'(x) = 1.099... \times 3^x$
$f(x) = 4^x$	$f'(x) = 1.386... \times 4^x$

Online Explore the relationship between exponential functions and their derivatives using GeoGebra.

- **For all real values of x:**
  - **If $f(x) = e^x$ then $f'(x) = e^x$**
  - **If $y = e^x$ then $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = e^x$**

A similar result holds for functions such as e^{5x}, e^{-x} and $e^{\frac{1}{2}x}$.

- **For all real values of x and for any constant k:**
  - **If $f(x) = e^{kx}$ then $f'(x) = ke^{kx}$**
  - **If $y = e^{kx}$ then $\dfrac{dy}{dx} = ke^{kx}$**

Example 3

Differentiate with respect to x.

a e^{4x} **b** $e^{-\frac{1}{2}x}$ **c** $3e^{2x}$

a $y = e^{4x}$

$\frac{dy}{dx} = 4e^{4x}$

b $y = e^{-\frac{1}{2}x}$

$\frac{dy}{dx} = -\frac{1}{2}e^{-\frac{1}{2}x}$

c $y = 3e^{2x}$

$\frac{dy}{dx} = 2 \times 3e^{2x} = 6e^{2x}$

Use the rule for differentiating e^{kx} with $k = 4$.

To differentiate ae^{kx} multiply the whole function by k. The derivative is kae^{kx}.

Example 4

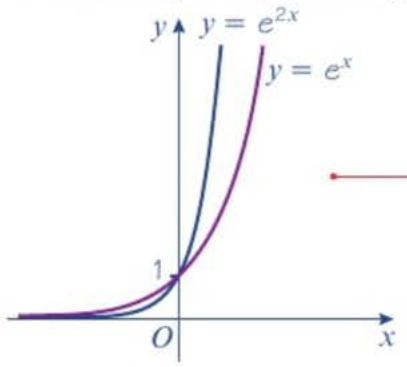
Sketch the graphs of the following equations. Give the coordinates of any points where the graphs cross the axes, and state the equations of any asymptotes.

a $y = e^{2x}$ **b** $y = 10e^{-x}$ **c** $y = 3 + 4e^{\frac{1}{2}x}$

a $y = e^{2x}$

When $x = 0$, $y = e^{2 \times 0} = 1$ so the graph crosses the y-axis at (0, 1).

The x-axis ($y = 0$) is an asymptote.



The graph of $y = e^x$ has been shown in purple on this sketch.

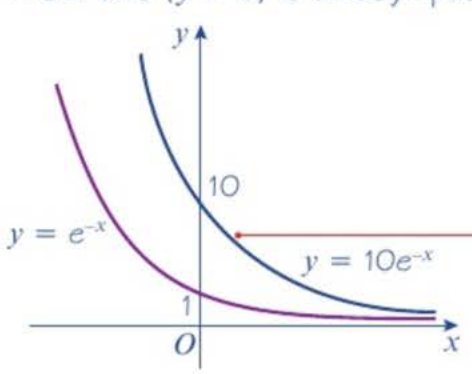
This is a stretch of the graph of $y = e^x$, parallel to the x-axis and with scale factor $\frac{1}{2}$

← Section 4.6

b $y = 10e^{-x}$

When $x = 0$, $y = 10e^{-0}$. So the graph crosses the y-axis at (0, 10).

The x-axis ($y = 0$) is an asymptote.



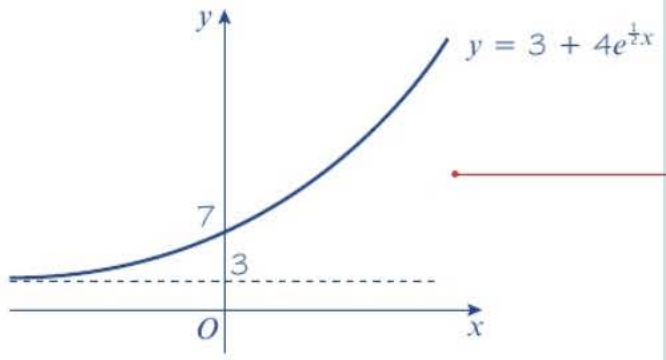
Negative powers of e^x, such as e^{-x} or e^{-4x}, give rise to decreasing functions.

The graph of $y = e^x$ has been reflected in the y-axis and stretched parallel to the y-axis with scale factor 10.

c $y = 3 + 4e^{\frac{1}{2}x}$

When $x = 0$, $y = 3 + 4e^{\frac{1}{2}\times 0} = 7$ so the graph crosses the y-axis at $(0, 7)$.

The line $y = 3$ is an asymptote.



Problem-solving

If you have to sketch a transformed graph with an asymptote, it is often easier to sketch the asymptote first.

The graph of $y = e^{\frac{1}{2}x}$ has been stretched parallel to the y-axis with scale factor 4 and then translated by $\begin{pmatrix}0\\3\end{pmatrix}$.

Online Use GeoGebra to draw transformations of $y = e^x$.



Exercise 14B

1 Use a calculator to find the value of e^x to 4 decimal places when

a $x = 1$ **b** $x = 4$ **c** $x = -10$ **d** $x = 0.2$

2 **a** Draw an accurate graph of $y = e^x$ for $-4 \leqslant x \leqslant 4$.

b By drawing appropriate tangent lines, estimate the gradient at $x = 1$ and $x = 3$.

c Compare your answers to the actual values of e and e^3.

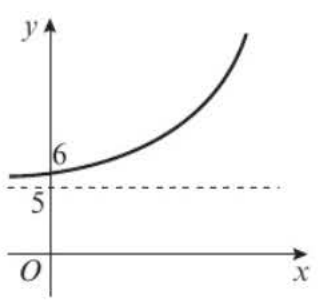
3 Sketch the graphs of:

a $y = e^{x+1}$ **b** $y = 4e^{-2x}$ **c** $y = 2e^x - 3$

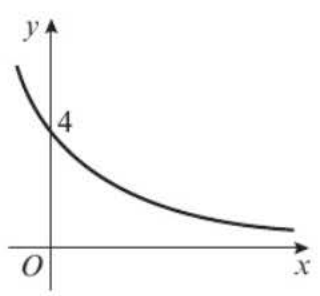
d $y = 4 - e^x$ **e** $y = 6 + 10e^{\frac{1}{2}x}$ **f** $y = 100e^{-x} + 10$

4 Each of the sketch graphs below is of the form $y = Ae^{bx} + C$, where A, b and C are constants. Find the values of A and C for each graph, and state whether b is positive or negative.

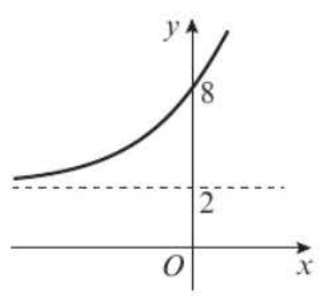
a



b



c



Hint You do not have enough information to work out the value of b, so simply state whether it is positive or negative.

5 Rearrange $f(x) = e^{3x+2}$ into the form $f(x) = Ae^{bx}$, where A and b are constants whose values are to be found. Hence, or otherwise, sketch the graph of $y = f(x)$.

Hint $e^{m+n} = e^m \times e^n$

6 Differentiate the following with respect to x.

a e^{6x} **b** $e^{-\frac{1}{3}x}$ **c** $7e^{2x}$

d $5e^{0.4x}$ **e** $e^{3x} + 2e^x$ **f** $e^x(e^x + 1)$

Hint For part **f**, start by expanding the bracket.

7 Find the gradient of the curve with equation $y = e^{3x}$ at the point where

a $x = 2$ **b** $x = 0$ **c** $x = -0.5$

(P) **8** The function f is defined as $f(x) = e^{0.2x}$, $x \in \mathbb{R}$. Show that the tangent to the curve at the point (5, e) goes through the origin.

14.3 Exponential modelling

You can use e^x to model situations such as population growth, where the rate of **increase** is proportional to the size of the population at any given moment. Similarly, e^{-x} can be used to model situations such as radioactive decay, where the rate of **decrease** is proportional to the number of atoms remaining.

Example 5

The density of a pesticide in a given section of field, P mg/m^2, can be modelled by the equation

$$P = 160e^{-0.006t}$$

where t is the time in days since the pesticide was first applied.

a Use this model to estimate the density of pesticide after 15 days.

b Interpret the meaning of the value 160 in this model.

c Show that $\frac{dP}{dt} = kP$, where k is a constant, and state the value of k.

d Interpret the significance of the sign of your answer to part **c**.

e Sketch the graph of P against t.

a After 15 days, $t = 15$.

$P = 160e^{-0.006 \times 15}$

$P = 146.2$ mg/m^2

Substitute $t = 15$ into the model.

b When $t = 0$, $P = 160e^0 = 160$, so 160 mg/m^2 is the initial density of pesticide in the field.

c $P = 160e^{-0.006t}$

$\frac{dP}{dt} = -0.96e^{-0.006t}$, so $k = -0.96$

$k = -0.006$

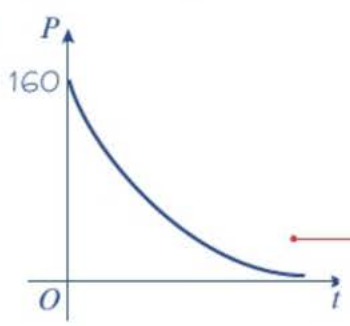
Online Work this out in one go using the $e^{\square}$ button on your calculator.

Notation The value given by a model when $t = 0$ is called the **initial value**.

If $y = e^{kx}$ then $\frac{dy}{dx} = ke^{kx}$

d As k is negative, the density of pesticide is decreasing (there is exponential decay).

e



Use your answers to parts **a** and **d** to help you draw the graph. To check what happens to P in the long term, substitute in a very large value of t.

14.7 Working with natural logarithms

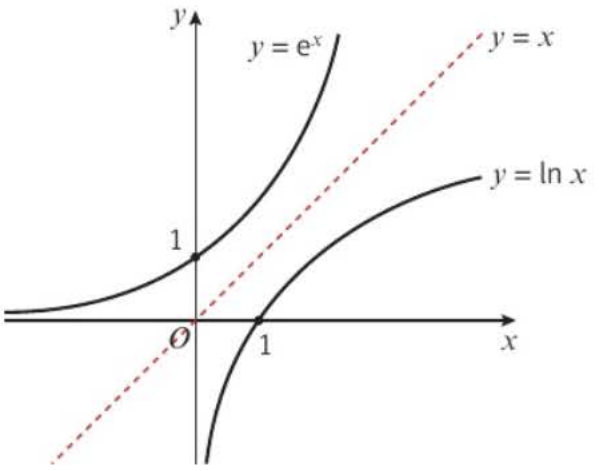
- **The graph of $y = \ln x$ is a reflection of the graph $y = e^x$ in the line $y = x$.**

The graph of $y = \ln x$ passes through $(1, 0)$ and does not cross the y-axis.

The y-axis is an asymptote of the graph $y = \ln x$. This means that $\ln x$ is only defined for positive values of x.

As x increases, $\ln x$ grows without limit, but relatively slowly.

You can also use the fact that logarithms are the inverses of exponential functions to solve equations involving powers and logarithms.



- $e^{\ln x} = \ln (e^x) = x$

Notation $\ln x = \log_e x$

Example 17

Solve these equations, giving your answers in exact form.

a $e^x = 5$ **b** $\ln x = 3$

a When $e^x = 5$

$\ln (e^x) = \ln 5$ — The inverse operation of raising e to the power x is taking natural logarithms (logarithms to the base e) and vice versa.

$x = \ln 5$

b When $\ln x = 3$

$e^{\ln x} = e^3$ — You can write the natural logarithm on both sides. $\ln (e^x) = x$

$x = e^3$ — Leave your answer as a logarithm or a power of e so that it is exact.

Example 18

Solve these equations, giving your answers in exact form.

a $e^{2x+3} = 7$ **b** $2 \ln x + 1 = 5$ **c** $e^{2x} + 5e^x = 14$

a $e^{2x+3} = 7$

$2x + 3 = \ln 7$ — Take natural logarithms of both sides and use the fact that the inverse of e^x is $\ln x$.

$2x = \ln 7 - 3$

$x = \frac{1}{2} \ln 7 - \frac{3}{2}$

b $2 \ln x + 1 = 5$

$2 \ln x = 4$ — Rearrange to make $\ln x$ the subject.

$\ln x = 2$ — The inverse of $\ln x$ is e^x.

$x = e^2$

c $e^{2x} + 5e^x = 14$

$e^{2x} + 5e^x - 14 = 0$

$(e^x + 7)(e^x - 2) = 0$

$e^x = -7$ or $e^x = 2$

$e^x = 2$

$x = \ln 2$

$e^{2x} = (e^x)^2$, so this is a quadratic function of e^x. Start by setting the equation equal to 0 and factorise. You could also use the substitution $u = e^x$ and write the equation as $u^2 + 5u - 14 = 0$.

Watch out e^x is always positive, so you can't have $e^x = -7$. You need to discard this solution.

Exercise 14G

1 Solve these equations, giving your answers in exact form.

a $e^x = 6$ **b** $e^{2x} = 11$ **c** $e^{-x+3} = 20$

d $3e^{4x} = 1$ **e** $e^{2x+6} = 3$ **f** $e^{5-x} = 19$

2 Solve these equations, giving your answers in exact form.

a $\ln x = 2$ **b** $\ln(4x) = 1$ **c** $\ln(2x + 3) = 4$

d $2\ln(6x - 2) = 5$ **e** $\ln(18 - x) = \frac{1}{2}$ **f** $\ln(x^2 - 7x + 11) = 0$

3 Solve these equations, giving your answers in exact form.

a $e^{2x} - 8e^x + 12 = 0$ **b** $e^{4x} - 3e^{2x} = -2$

c $(\ln x)^2 + 2\ln x - 15 = 0$ **d** $e^x - 5 + 4e^{-x} = 0$

e $3e^{2x} + 5 = 16e^x$ **f** $(\ln x)^2 = 4(\ln x + 3)$

Hint All of the equations in question 3 are quadratic equations in a function of x.

Hint First in part **d** multiply each term by e^x.

E/P **4** Find the exact solutions to the equation $e^x + 12e^{-x} = 7$. **(4 marks)**

5 Solve these equations, giving your answers in exact form.

a $\ln(8x - 3) = 2$ **b** $e^{5(x-8)} = 3$ **c** $e^{10x} - 8e^{5x} + 7 = 0$

d $(\ln x - 1)^2 = 4$

E/P **6** Solve $3^x e^{4x-1} = 5$, giving your answer in the form $\frac{a + \ln b}{c + \ln d}$ **(5 marks)**

Hint Take natural logarithms of both sides and then apply the laws of logarithms.

P **7** Officials are testing athletes for doping at a sporting event. They model the concentration of a particular drug in an athlete's bloodstream using the equation $D = 6e^{\frac{-t}{10}}$ where D is the concentration of the drug in mg/l and t is the time in hours since the athlete took the drug.

a Interpret the meaning of the constant 6 in this model.

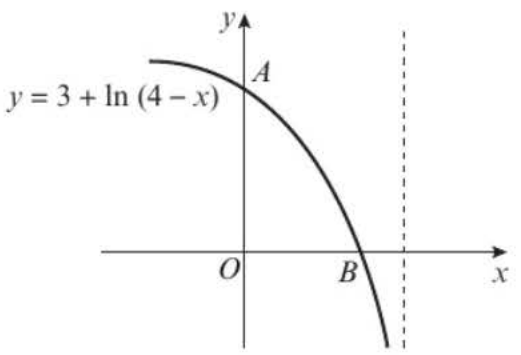
b Find the concentration of the drug in the bloodstream after 2 hours.

c It is impossible to detect this drug in the bloodstream if the concentration is lower than 3 mg/l. Show that this happens after $t = -10\ln\left(\frac{1}{2}\right)$ and convert this result into hours and minutes.

E/P **8** The graph of $y = 3 + \ln(4 - x)$ is shown to the right.

a State the exact coordinates of point A. **(1 mark)**

b Calculate the exact coordinates of point B. **(3 marks)**



Challenge

The graph of the function $g(x) = Ae^{Bx} + C$ passes through $(0, 5)$ and $(6, 10)$.
Given that the line $y = 2$ is an asymptote to the graph, show that $B = \frac{1}{6}\ln\left(\frac{8}{3}\right)$.

14.8 Logarithms and non-linear data

Logarithms can also be used to manage and explore non-linear trends in data.

Case 1: $y = ax^n$

Start with a non-linear relationship —— $y = ax^n$
Take logs of both sides (log = $\log_{10}$) —— $\log y = \log ax^n$
Use the multiplication law —— $\log y = \log a + \log x^n$
Use the power law —— $\log y = \log a + n \log x$
Compare this equation to the common form of a straight line, $Y = MX + C$.

$\log y$	=	n	$\log x$	+	$\log a$
variable		constant (gradient)	variable		constant (intercept)

Y	=	M	X	+	C
variable		constant (gradient)	variable		constant (intercept)

- **If $y = ax^n$ then the graph of $\log y$ against $\log x$ will be a straight line with gradient n and vertical intercept $\log a$.**

